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Canada’s privacy commissioners

Joint investigation of Clearview AI, Inc. by the Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada, the Commission d’accès à l’information du Québec, the Information and Privacy Commissioner for British Columbia, and the Information Privacy Commissioner of Alberta

PIPEDA Findings #2021-001

February 2, 2021

Quotes:

“What Clearview does is mass surveillance and it is illegal. It is completely unacceptable for millions of people who will never be implicated in any crime to find themselves continually in a police lineup. Yet the company continues to claim its purposes were appropriate, citing the requirement under federal privacy law that its business needs be balanced against privacy rights. Parliamentarians reviewing Bill C-11 may wish to send a clear message, through that bill, that where there is a conflict between commercial objectives and privacy protection, Canadians’ privacy rights should prevail.” – Daniel Therrien, Privacy Commissioner of Canada.

Canada’s privacy commissioners

2–3 February 2021 · PIPEDA Findings #2021-001 and news release · Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada · Extracts printed from priv.gc.ca

The joint investigation by Canada’s federal commissioner and three provincial commissioners found that Clearview’s scraping was mass surveillance and broke Canadian law. Clearview disputed the findings and withdrew from Canada.

Source: priv.gc.ca. The full news release is on the desk.